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The Road to Sustainability is Paved with Cities

by [Nick Pillsbury](#)

He/Him

The Road to Sustainability Is Paved With Cities Not Trees



What do you think
of when you hear
"Sustainability"?

You probably think about safeguarding **Land** and **Ocean** ecosystems, Combating **Climate Change**, or expanding the availability of **Renewal Energy**! But that only covers **5** of the **17**...

SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

In reality, many of us think of sustainability in the context of resource consumption and preservation. **The Sustainable Development Goals** (SDGs) expand beyond this to tackle the numerous detriments to sustainability progress. After all, how can you prioritize sustainable practices in the face of starvation, hunger, or war?

Hover to see each SDG and their full description!

1 NO POVERTY



5 GENDER EQUALITY



9 INDUSTRY, AND INFRA



13 CLIMATE ACTION



17 PARTNERSHIPS FOR THE GOALS



But goals don't just 'appear' one day. How did we pick these **17 SDGs**?

Below is a **very** simplified timeline leading up to the **2015 Millennium Development Goals**. What started as a mix of **health indicators** which make for a more sustainable world.

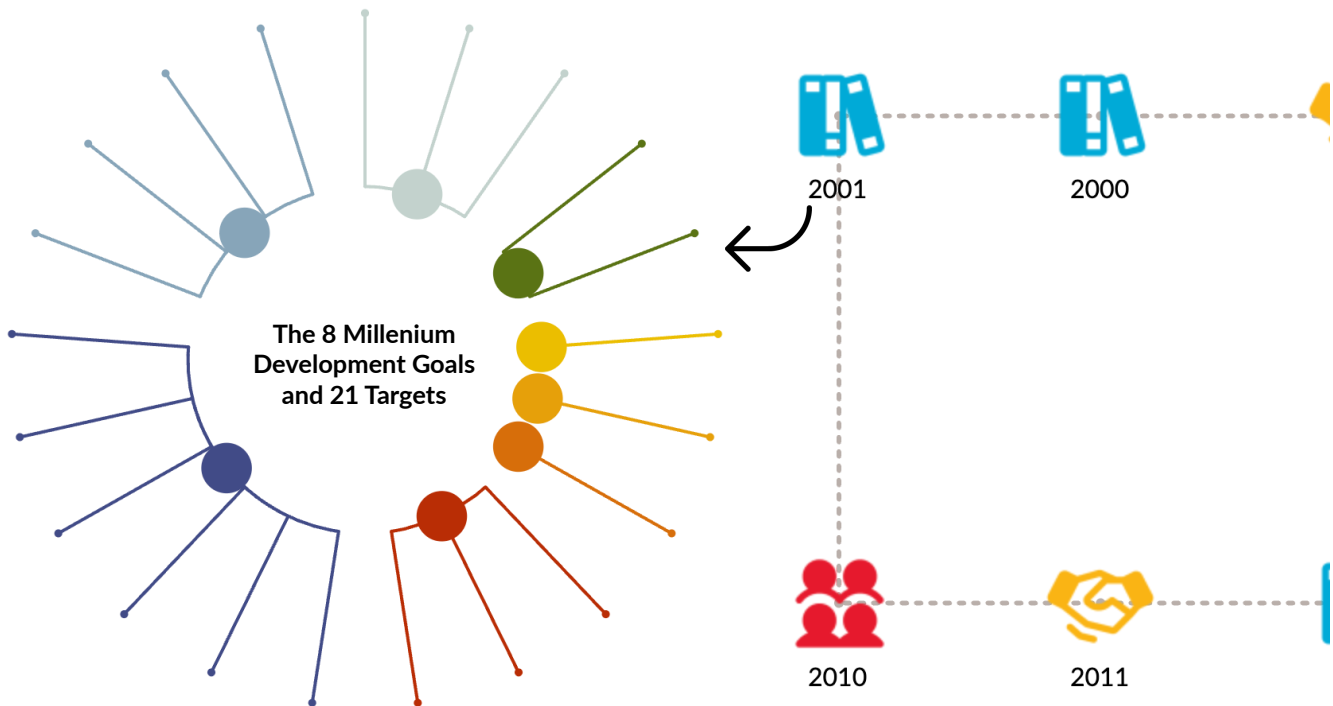
Hover over timeline events to learn more about them!

"**Sustainable Development** is development that meets the needs of the present **without compromising the ability of future generations** to meet their own needs."

~ "Our Common Future", Chapter 2: Towards Sustainable Development. 1983



1983



We've made amazing progress, but the **2025 Sustainability Report** cautions there is still a long way to go.



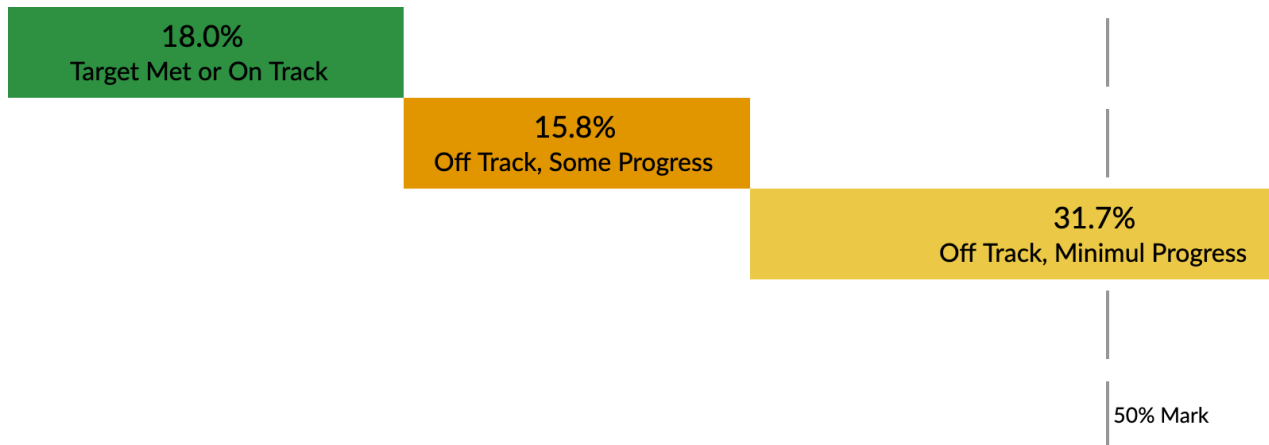
2025

"So where are we today?"

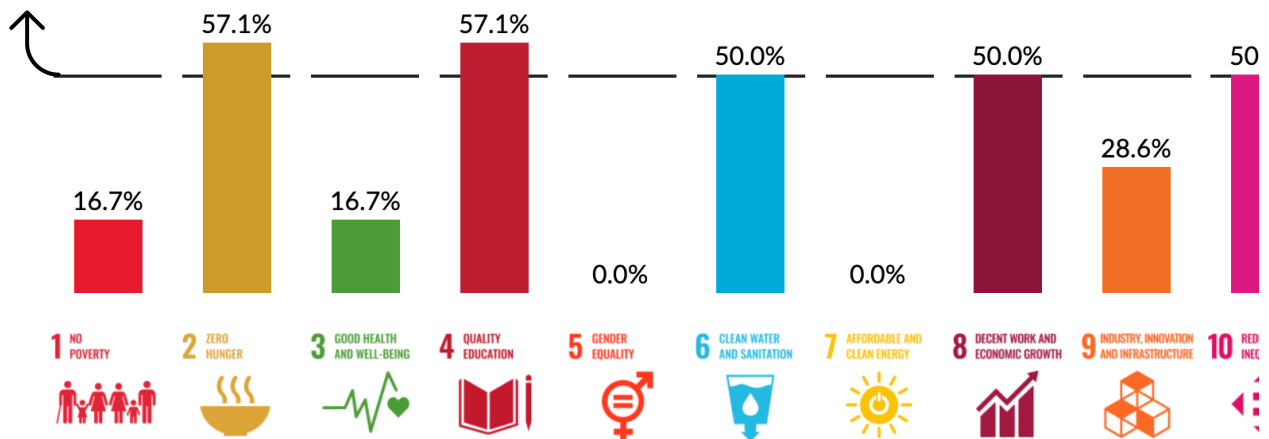


Below is the latest **2025 Target Status** showing if were **on track**
 Each goal has its own targets, but unfortunately progress has not
 Only **18%** of Goals are on track, with only another **15.8%** showing
 not **worsening!**

Click any of the goals below to see their 2025 waterfall of progress. **The high**



5 SDGs show **50% or more** of their targets are **Stagnate** or **Worsening** as of 2025



The numbers above match what's reported in the **progress update**. However, you know

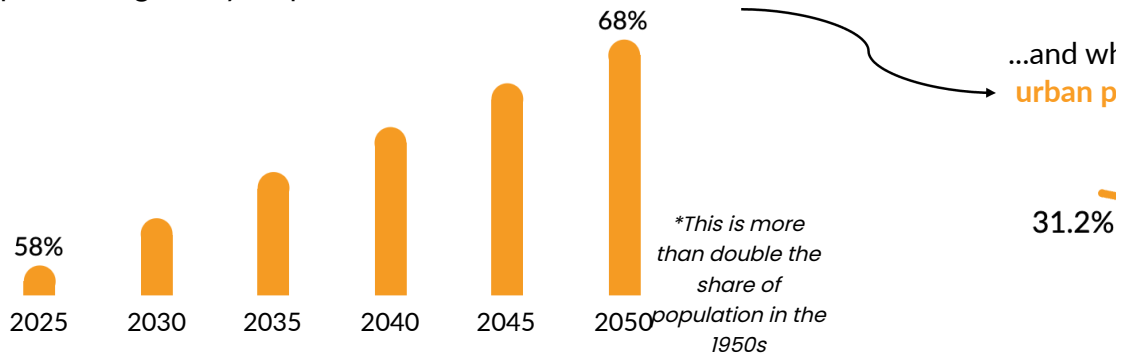
"You only Improve what you

And in reality, many goals currently
 Click the toggle to the right to show how many
 tracking

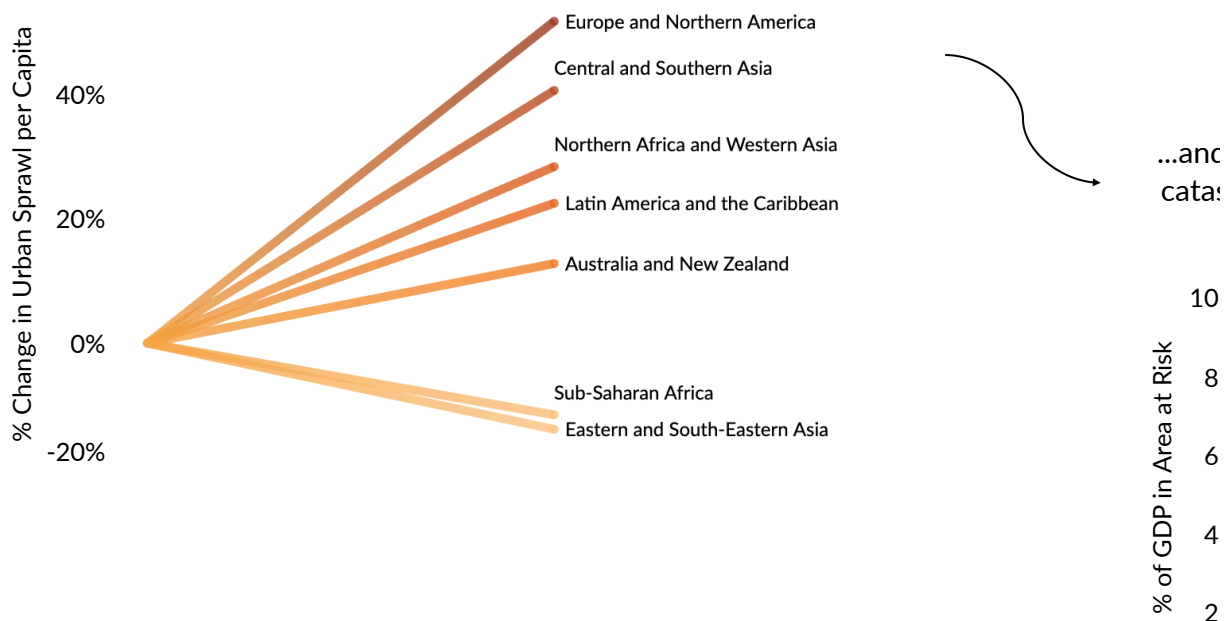
You might ask "So how does **City Development** relate to **Sustainability**?
Like building more wind turbines?"

Responsible construction and **city** **occupy**, and **safeguard resource** **Sustainable Development**. As the (fact), they remain a major source
And so, **Urban Development** will c

... because the % of the global **Population living in Cities** is expected to grow by 10 pts between now and **2050*** ...



...but, **Cities are consuming more land per capita** than in the past, as high as 50% in North America & Europe



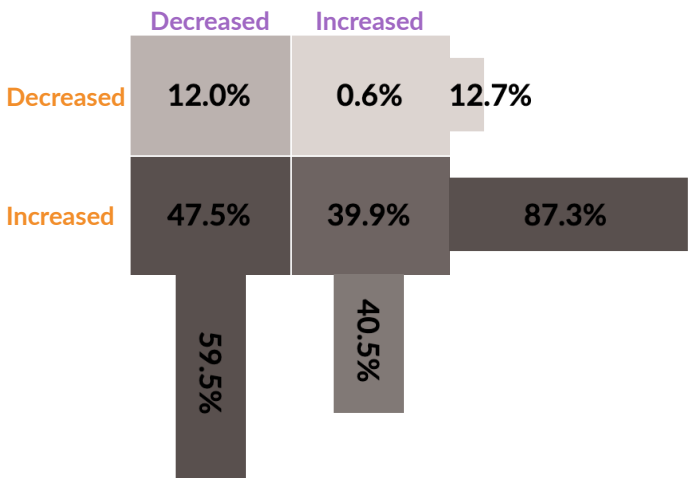
The rising urban populations are rapidly developing in

THE rising urban populations are rapidly developing in unsustainable ways. The increasing frequency of "once in a life time" storms puts the whole global economy at risk, as more of the working population gathers in high risk zones.

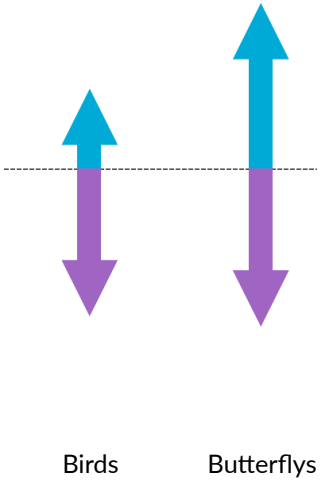
"Aren't human populations expected to decrease? So won't we naturally become more sustainable?"

Many people believe that as global populations begin control is an important aspect of environmental sustainability. decreases: Japan and Italy, which are known as "Depopulated". However, case studies in these regions warn us that :

In a 2025 study of Japanese Population, Urbanization, and Wildlife trends 47% of researched Cities showed increasing urban sprawl despite decreasing Human population.



Additionally, agricultural land use decreased in 48% of sites with decreasing populations



Less cultivation from Diversity
In over 50% of cities, populations. Turns out, areas where we noted above do:

Details

A breakdown of the 2025 Sustainable Development Report, focusing on Goal 11 (Sustainable Cities) and how sometimes "Less People" doesn't mean "Less Problems". Learn more about the UN-SDGs today! [#Vizcon2025](#).

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